

SCHEDULE OF MEETINGS

UNIT 1: Political Obligation: <i>Is there a duty to obey the law?</i>		
DATE	TOPIC / READING (page count)	ASSIGNMENTS / REMINDERS
Wednesday Jan 21	<u>Welcome & Introductions</u> Course Syllabus	
Monday Jan 26	<u>The Classic Statement</u> Plato, <i>Crito</i> (12)	Intro PRRs .
Wednesday Jan 28	<u>The Problem and Its Significance</u> - F&A - Simmons Ch. 5 + Ch 6, pp. 93-111 (18) - F&A - Wellman Ch. 1, pp. 3-12 (10)	PRR 1
Monday Feb 2	<u>Associative Theories: Various</u> - F&A - Simmons 1996a (28) - F&A - Simmons Ch. 6, pp. 111-115 (4)	PRR 2 Last day to <i>add</i> classes.
Wednesday Feb 4	<u>Transactional Theories: Fair Play</u> Hart 1955, pp. 185-6 (sec. iii) (2) Rawls 1964 (14)	PRR 3
Monday Feb 9	<u>Transactional Theories: Fair Play</u> Simmons 1979 (26) - F&A - Simmons Ch 6, pp. 115-120 (5)	PRR 4
Wednesday Feb 11	<u>Natural Duty Theories: Justice as Fairness</u> Rawls 1971, Ch. 1, pp. 3-27 (sec. 1-5) (25)	PRR 5
Monday Feb 16	<u>Natural Duty Theories (for): Samaritanism</u> F&A - Wellman Ch. 1, pp. 12-29 (17)	PRR 6
Wednesday Feb 18	<u>Natural Duty Theories (for): Samaritanism</u> F&A - Wellman Ch. 2 (23)	PRR 7 Essay Phase 1 due Fri, Feb 20.
Monday Feb 23	<u>Natural Duty Theories (against): Necessity & Deference</u> F&A - Simmons Ch. 7, pp. 121-150 (30)	PRR 8
Wednesday Feb 25	<u>Natural Duty Theories (against): Rawls & Samaritanism</u> F&A - Simmons Ch. 7, pp. 150-188 (39)	PRR 9
Monday Mar 2	<u>Philosophical Anarchism</u> Simmons 1996b (20)	PRR 10 Peer Feedback due in class.
Wednesday Mar 4	<u>Confronting Injustice</u> King 1963 (14) - F&A - Wellman Ch. 4 (16)	PRR 11

UNIT 2: Political Responsibility: *Structural Injustice, Resistance & Social Change*

DATE	TOPIC / READING	ASSIGNMENTS / REMINDERS
Monday Mar 9	<u>Civil Disobedience Reconsidered</u> • Lyons 1998 (19)	PRR 12
Wednesday Mar 11	<u>Apportioning Responsibilities</u> • Goodin 1987 (18)	PRR 13 Last day to <i>drop</i> : Thurs, Mar 12. Essay Phase 2 due Sun, Mar 15.
Mar 16-20	NO CLASS: Spring Break	
Monday Mar 23	<u>From Personal to Political Responsibility</u> • Young 2011 Ch. 1 (22)	PRR 14
Wednesday Mar 25	<u>Structure as the Subject of Justice</u> • Young 2011 Ch. 2 (18)	PRR 15
Monday Mar 30	<u>Guilt versus Responsibility</u> • Young 2011 Ch. 3 (11)	PRR 16
Wednesday Apr 1	<u>A Social Connection Model</u> • Young 2011 Ch. 4 (16)	PRR 17
Monday Apr 6	<u>With Power Comes Responsibility</u> • McKeown 2024 Ch. 6 (23)	PRR 18 Fall 2026 courses visible online.
Wednesday Apr 8	<u>A Duty to Resist?</u> • Delmas 2018 Intro (20)	PRR 19
Monday Apr 13	<u>Principled Disobedience</u> • Delmas 2018 Ch. 1	PRR 20
Wednesday Apr 15	<u>In Defence of Uncivil Disobedience</u> • Delmas 2018 Ch. 2	PRR 21 Last day to <i>withdraw</i> : Fri, Apr 17.
Monday Apr 20	<u>Acting On Political Obligations</u> • Delmas 2018 Ch. 7	PRR 22
Wednesday Apr 22	<u>The Problem of Either/Or Thinking</u> • Brownstein et al. 2025, Intro + Part I	PRR 23
Monday Apr 27	<u>A Better Picture of Social Change</u> • Brownstein et al. 2025, Part II	PRR 24
Wednesday Apr 29	<u>Putting It Into Practice 1</u> • Brownstein et al. 2025, Chs. 9-11	PRR 25

Monday May 4	<u>Putting It Into Practice 2</u> • Brownstein et al. 2025, Chs. 12-14 • Visit from Dr. Alex Madva	
Wednesday May 6	<u>Wrap-Up & Final Prep</u>	Bring your study questions. Last day of classes.
May 7-8	READING DAYS	
Tuesday May 12	Final Exam (25%)	Usual Classroom, 2:00 - 5:00 PM. Bring your laptop (test is on EBB).
Thursday May 21	Grades Due to Registrar	

FAQ

- 1. Do I need to make an appointment to come speak with you during office hours?**
 No. Office hours are drop-in, so just go ahead and stop by. You're welcome to email to let me know *when* you plan on coming by, if you'd like.
- 2. I didn't have time to do the readings for today. Should I still come to class?**
 Absolutely. There's no penalty for failing to do the reading on time, and nothing at all to gain by opting out of our in-class discussions. Showing up and doing your best to follow along and take part is in everyone's best interests.
- 3. Why did I get a *not-pass* (X) on my PRR?**
 Most likely because your submission ran afoul of some element of the criteria. Take another look at the "Personal Reading Response" section, above to confirm.
- 4. I didn't complete my PRR because (*insert explanation*). Can I still get credit for it?**
 No. PRRs must be submitted to me at the end of class, or ahead of time. There are no exceptions. See the section on PRRs above for full details.
- 5. I'm having a hard time with the readings. Should I use the internet to help?**
 I advise against it. A lot of what's online is trash, and since evaluation in this class will be tailored to our in-class activities, even good sources may be misleading. I recommend coming into office hours; I've got some strategies that can help.
- 6. I'm having a hard time with in-class discussion. What should I do?**
 It depends on the nature of the difficulty. I recommend coming into office hours, and we will do our best to figure out a solution that works for you.